

Sunday, 28 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 25° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 23° 16°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 22° 16°	GLASGOW Light rain 18° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The UK's record-breaking heatwave is set to finally break this weekend, with cooler, more unsettled weather moving in.

An amber extreme heat warning has been extended, but forecasters say the intense heat will give way to more typical British summer weather by Sunday. It's certainly been one to remember!

WEATHER · UK
- 2

A murder investigation has been launched after a three-year-old girl was found dead.

Police say a man was taken to hospital with a serious injury and will be taken into custody once treated. It's a truly tragic story.

CRIME · UK
- 3

A 17-year-old boy has died, and three others were seriously injured, in a crash near Beachy Head.

Sussex Police confirmed three men, aged between 19 and 21, were hurt in the incident. Our thoughts are with everyone affected.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 4

A body has been found in the search for a missing teenage swimmer in a lake.

The 15-year-old boy was reported missing after he was last seen swimming in Testwood Lakes on Wednesday. A very sad development.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 5

Lightning strikes have caused fires and significant damage to homes across the South East.

Crews in Kent and Sussex have dealt with six blazes caused by the strikes, triggered by the intense heat. A dramatic end to the heatwave for some.

WEATHER · UK

What's coming up

1

A new BBC drama about The Beatles' early days, 'Hamburg Days', has cast its lead star.

The six-part series will chart the band's growth from their beginnings in Germany. It sounds like a fascinating look at their formative years.

ON AIR – Are you excited for a new drama about The Beatles? What's your favourite Beatles-related film or show?
TV · COMING UP

2

If you're missing Glastonbury, don't worry – there are plenty of local festivals happening this weekend across the UK!

Stars like Fatboy Slim and Becky Hill are playing smaller venues to celebrate the vibrant UK music scene. It's a great chance to catch some big names closer to home.

ON AIR – Are you heading to any local festivals this summer, or do you prefer the big ones? What's the best local gig you've ever been to?
MUSIC · THIS WEEKEND

3

DC Studios boss says the comics giant needs to win back fans' trust with its upcoming 'Supergirl' movie.

The latest release is part of a wider reset of their cinematic universe. They're hoping to turn things around for their superhero franchise.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the DC movies, or do you prefer Marvel? What do you think they need to do to win fans back?
FILM · COMING UP

4

Canada could soon be joining the Eurovision Song Contest, according to their Prime Minister!

Mark Carney raised the idea in his 2025 budget, suggesting Canada could become eligible. Imagine the transatlantic competition!

ON AIR – Would you like to see Canada join Eurovision? Which other countries would you love to see compete?
TV · FUTURE

5

Plymouth's 'The Box' museum and gallery has been crowned the UK's 'Museum of the Year'!

It's been described as a 'true jewel' and received the prestigious 2026 Art Fund Museum of the Year award. A fantastic achievement for the venue.

ON AIR – Have you ever visited 'The Box' in Plymouth, or do you have a favourite local museum or gallery? What makes it special?
ARTS · UK

On the schedule

1 **George Russell has claimed a controversial pole position at the Austrian Grand Prix after a crash involving Max Verstappen.**

The Mercedes driver stole pole from Charles Leclerc with his last lap of the session. It's set to be an exciting race after that dramatic qualifying!

ON AIR – What do you make of Russell's controversial pole? Do you think the crash affected the outcome unfairly?
F1 · UK

2 **Wales beat the Barbarians 33-31 in a thrilling match at Twickenham, as George North signed off his career in style.**

North scored two tries in his final rugby match, making it a memorable farewell. What a way for a legend to end his career!

ON AIR – What's your favourite George North memory? Who's the greatest rugby player you've ever seen retire?
RUGBY · UK

3 **Madison Keys has secured her third Eastbourne title, beating Tatjana Maria in the final.**

The American second seed won 7-5, 6-4 in a dominant performance. She clearly loves playing on the grass courts here!

ON AIR – Do you enjoy watching the tennis at Eastbourne, or is Wimbledon your main focus? Who are you backing for Wimbledon this year?
TENNIS · UK

4 **England lost three early wickets on day three of the third Test against New Zealand at Trent Bridge.**

Joe Root, Jacob Bethell and Jamie Smith were all dismissed for just eleven runs. It's been a tough start to the day for the England batters.

ON AIR – Are you following the Test match? What do you think England needs to do to turn things around today?
CRICKET · UK

5 **Jannik Sinner is the strong favourite to retain his Wimbledon title, despite a shock early loss at the French Open.**

With rival Carlos Alcaraz absent, Sinner is looking to resume his dominance on the grass courts. Can anyone stop him at SW19?

ON AIR – Who are you tipping for the men's singles title at Wimbledon this year? Do you think Sinner will live up to the favourite tag?
TENNIS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people transforming old phone boxes into mini libraries and art galleries.**
Communities across the UK are embracing the quirky idea, giving these iconic red structures a new lease of life as hubs for books and local artwork, much to the delight of residents.
- 2 Researchers suggest that listening to rain sounds can significantly boost concentration and relaxation.**
Apparently, the consistent, non-intrusive nature of rainfall audio helps to mask distracting background noises, creating an ideal environment for focus or winding down after a long day.
- 3 The simple pleasure of 'baking bread from scratch' is experiencing a big revival.**
More home cooks are finding joy in the therapeutic process of kneading dough and the satisfaction of a freshly baked loaf, with social media awash with impressive homemade creations.
- 4 A study reveals that the colour of your coffee mug can actually influence how you perceive its taste.**
It seems darker mugs tend to make coffee taste more intense, while lighter ones can make it seem sweeter. Something to ponder with your next cuppa!
- 5 The art of 'pressed flower crafts' is blooming again, captivating a new generation of enthusiasts.**
From intricate greeting cards to decorative resin art, people are rediscovering the delicate beauty of preserving flowers, turning fleeting blossoms into lasting keepsakes.
- 6 Experts are highlighting the surprising benefits of 'daydreaming' for creativity and problem-solving.**
Allowing your mind to wander can actually help connect disparate ideas and spark innovative solutions, proving that a little mental meandering isn't just idleness.
- 7 The popularity of 'board game cafes' is soaring, offering a social alternative to traditional pubs.**
These welcoming venues provide a fun space for friends and families to connect over a wide array of classic and modern board games, often with a cuppa and a slice of cake.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're alone in the house, even though we know we probably look a bit silly?

ANSWER: HAVING A FULL-BLOWN CONVERSATION WITH OUR PETS, AS IF THEY COMPLETELY UNDERSTAND!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'mug' that we absolutely have to use for our morning tea or coffee. What is it?

ANSWER: OUR FAVOURITE, MOST COMFORTABLE, SLIGHTLY CHIPPED MUG THAT JUST 'FEELS' RIGHT!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those little 'sound triggers' that instantly transport us back to a specific memory or feeling, don't we?**

What's a particular sound that, no matter where you hear it, instantly takes you back to a cherished moment or place? Give us a call and share your sonic nostalgia!

- **You know how sometimes you try a 'new way of doing things' around the house, and it turns out to be an absolute game-changer?**

What's a clever little 'life hack' or 'shortcut' you've discovered for household chores or daily routines that you now can't live without? Ring in and share your wisdom!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a parliament? This unique term supposedly comes from C.S. Lewis's 'The Chronicles of Narnia', where a gathering of owls advises the lion Aslan.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that the only mammal capable of true sustained flight is the bat? All other flying mammals, like sugar gliders, merely glide from high points.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£59 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£59 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's oldest known living tree is a Great Basin bristlecone pine named Methuselah, estimated to be over 4,800 years old, located in the White Mountains of California.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest; they have been observed at altitudes of over 9,000 metres (29,500 feet).
- The 'electric eel' can produce an electric shock of up to 600 volts, enough to knock a horse off its feet.
- Despite their name, 'killer whales' (or orcas) are actually the largest species of dolphin.
- The Great Barrier Reef is so vast that it can be seen from outer space, stretching for over 2,300 kilometres (1,400 miles) off the coast of Queensland, Australia.
- A newborn kangaroo is about the size of a jelly bean when it is born.
- The 'Panda's thumb' is not a true digit but an elongated wrist bone that acts like a thumb, helping it grip bamboo.
- The distinctive stripes on a zebra are like human fingerprints – no two zebras have the exact same pattern.

On this day

Day 179 of the year, 186 days left in 2026. Today International LGBTQ Pride Day, marking the anniversary of Stonewall riots.; Christian feast day: Basilides and Potamiana; Christian feast day: Irenaeus of Lyon (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Heimerad. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — Clint Boon, English singer and keyboard player
- 1948 — Deborah Moggach, English author and screenwriter
- 1966 — Bobby Bare Jr., American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1945 — Ken Buchanan, Scottish boxer (died 2023)
- 1971 — Aileen Quinn, American actress and singer
- 1970 — Mike White, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1986 — Kellie Pickler, American singer-songwriter
- 1951 — Lalla Ward, English actress and author

THE DAY TODAY

- 2001 — Slobodan Milošević is extradited to the ICTY in The Hague to stand trial.
- 1976 — The Angolan court sentences US and UK mercenaries to death sentences and prison terms in the Luanda Trial.
- 1936 — The Japanese puppet state of Mengjiang is formed in northern China.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1948 — Boxer Dick Turpin beats Vince Hawkins at Villa Park in Birmingham to become the first black British boxing champion in the modern era.
- 1978 — The United States Supreme Court, in Regents of the University of California v. Bakke bars quota systems in college admissions.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1945 — Poland's Soviet-allied Provisional Government of National Unity is formed over a month after V-E Day.
- 1969 — Stonewall riots begin in New York City, marking the start of the Gay Rights Movement.

- 1942 — World War II: Nazi Germany starts its strategic summer offensive against the Soviet Union, codenamed Case Blue.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 180 of the year, 185 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Cassius of Narni; Christian feast day: Hemma of Gurk; Christian feast day: Mary, mother of John Mark; Christian feast day: Feast of Saints Peter and Paul (Western Christianity), and its related observances: Haro Wine Festival (Haro, La Rioja). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Gary Busey, American actor
- 1953 — Don Dokken, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1950 — Don Moen, American singer and songwriter
- 1991 — Addison Timlin, American actress
- 1970 — Emily Skinner, American actress and singer
- 1993 — Oliver Tree, American singer-songwriter (died 2026)
- 1943 — Little Eva, American singer (died 2003)
- 1965 — Paul Jarvis, English cricketer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1987 — Vincent van Gogh's painting, the Le Pont de Trinquetaille, is bought for \$20.4 million at an auction in London, England.
- 1950 — Korean War: U.S. President Harry S. Truman authorizes a sea blockade of Korea.
- 1975 — Pope Paul VI ordains some 350 priests in St. Peter's Square in the largest ordination in history

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2007 — Apple Inc. releases its first mobile phone, the iPhone.
- 2006 — Hamdan v. Rumsfeld: The U.S. Supreme Court rules that President George W. Bush's plan to try Guantanamo Bay detainees in military tribunals violates U.S. and international law.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)